John 10 - 12

Key Notes, Cross-References, and Prophecy Fulfilled (WEB)

A sheepfold with one door, a thief who climbs in another way, and a shepherd who calls his sheep by name.

I am the door. I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.

Then winter, and the Feast of Dedication, and men in Solomon's porch saying: how long will you keep us in suspense? Tell us plainly.

I and the Father are one.

And the stones come out again.

Then a message from Bethany. Lord, the one You love is sick.

And He waits two more days.

By the time He arrives, Lazarus has been in the tomb four days. Martha meets Him on the road. Lord, if You had been here, my brother would not have died.

I am the resurrection and the life.

Then Mary comes, and falls at His feet, and says the very same sentence her sister said. And He does not explain anything to her.

He weeps.

Then a stone rolled back, and a loud voice, and a dead man walking out still wrapped in his grave clothes.

Loose him, and let him go.

And the very miracle that should have ended all argument is the one that gets Him killed. A high priest stands up in council and says it is better for one man to die for the people.

And John says he was prophesying, and did not know it.

Then a dinner in Bethany, and a pound of pure nard poured on His feet, and the whole house filled with the smell of it.

Then palm branches and Hosanna, and a King riding in on a donkey's colt.

Then Greeks who say: Sir, we want to see Jesus.

And His answer is about a grain of wheat that has to fall into the ground and die.

Now My soul is troubled. Father, save Me from this hour? No. For this I came.

And John closes the public ministry with Isaiah: who has believed our report? And then the line that tells you who Isaiah saw on the throne.

Isaiah said these things when he saw His glory, and spoke of Him.

This is not just history.

This is a mirror.

And tonight, we let the Word fill us.

CHAPTER 10 - The Door, the Good Shepherd, and I and the Father Are One

Key Notes

- There is no break between chapters 9 and 10. The shepherds He is describing are the same men who just threw a healed sheep out of the fold (John 10:1, 9:34).
- A sheepfold was a walled enclosure, often shared by several flocks overnight. A thief does not use the door because the doorkeeper knows who belongs and who does not (John 10:1-3).
- “He calls his own sheep by name.” Shepherds in the region still do this, and the sheep come. Yahweh told Moses I know you by name, and told Jacob I have called you by your name, you are mine (John 10:3, Exodus 33:17, Isaiah 43:1).
- “He goes before them.” An eastern shepherd leads from the front. The sheep follow a voice, not a stick (John 10:4).
- John calls it a paroimia, a figure of speech, and says they did not understand it. So He tells it again from another angle (John 10:6).
- “I am the door” is the third of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. A shepherd would sometimes sleep across the gap in the wall. He was literally the door (John 10:7, 10:9).
- “Will go in and go out, and will find pasture” is covenant language for a life safely led. Moses asked for a man who would go out and come in before the people, so they would not be like sheep without a shepherd (John 10:9, Numbers 27:17).
- “The thief only comes to steal, kill, and destroy. I came that they may have life, and may have it abundantly.” Abundantly means beyond what is needed, overflowing. He did not come to keep people barely alive (John 10:10, Psalm 36:8).
- “Good shepherd” uses kalos, which means good in the sense of noble, beautiful, the real thing - as opposed to the worthless shepherds condemned by the prophets (John 10:11, Zechariah 11:17).
- Ezekiel 34 is the background of the whole chapter. Yahweh condemns the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves, and then says: I myself will search for my sheep, I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep. And then: I will set up one shepherd over them, my servant David. Both are true of Yahshua at once (John 10:11, Ezekiel 34:2, 34:15, 34:23).
- “Lays down his life for the sheep.” A shepherd might risk his life for the flock. This one plans to give it, and says so five times in the chapter (John 10:11, 15, 17, 18).
- The hired hand flees when the wolf comes because the sheep are not his. You find out who owns the flock when it costs something (John 10:12-13).
- “I know my own, and I’m known by my own; even as the Father knows me, and I know the Father.” The way He knows His sheep is compared to the way He and the Father know each other (John 10:14-15).

- “Other sheep, which are not of this fold” is usually read of the nations coming in. Ezekiel 37 speaks of the two houses, Judah and Joseph, gathered back as one nation with one shepherd over them. Either way the destination is the same: one flock, one shepherd (John 10:16, Ezekiel 37:22-24).
- “I lay down my life, that I may take it again. No one takes it away from me.” The cross was not something that happened to Him. He had authority to lay it down and authority to take it up (John 10:17-18).
- The Feast of Dedication remembers the cleansing and rededication of the temple after Antiochus Epiphanes defiled it, nearly two hundred years earlier. It is not one of the appointed times in Leviticus 23. John simply records that Yahshua was in the temple at that time, in winter (John 10:22-23).
- Solomon’s porch was a covered colonnade along the east side of the temple court, a place out of the winter weather. The early believers later met there (John 10:23, Acts 5:12).
- “How long will you hold us in suspense?” is literally how long will you take away our life, or lift up our soul. They want a straight answer they can use (John 10:24).
- “No one will snatch them out of my hand… no one is able to snatch them out of my Father’s hand.” The same hand, said two ways. Yahweh says in Isaiah: there is no one who can deliver out of my hand (John 10:28-29, Isaiah 43:13).
- “I and the Father are one” uses one in the neuter, hen - one thing, not one person. It is the unity of the Shema, Yahweh is one, spoken from inside it (John 10:30, Deuteronomy 6:4).
- They pick up stones because, as they say, you, being a man, make yourself God. Once again His enemies understood Him more clearly than many readers since (John 10:31-33).
- “I said, you are gods” is Psalm 82, which Yahshua calls your law - the word could cover the whole of Scripture. In the psalm God stands among those He calls gods and sons of the Most High and says they will die like men. Readers divide over whether they are Israel’s judges or the heavenly council; the argument works either way (John 10:34, Psalm 82:6-7).
- The argument runs from lesser to greater. If Scripture can call them gods, how can you call it blasphemy when the one the Father set apart and sent says I am the Son of God? (John 10:35-36).
- “The Scripture can’t be broken” is said in passing, as something everyone in the conversation already agreed on (John 10:35).
- “Sanctified and sent” - set apart and sent - is said at the feast of setting apart. Dedication remembered an altar consecrated again; He claims to be the one the Father consecrated (John 10:36).
- He goes back across the Jordan to where John first baptized. The ministry ends near where it began (John 10:40, 1:28).
- “John did no sign, but everything John said about this man is true.” The best thing ever said about a preacher (John 10:41).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Shepherds Who Feed Themselves	John 10:1 • Ezekiel 34:2-3 • Jeremiah 23:1-2
He Calls His Own by Name	John 10:3 • Isaiah 43:1 • Exodus 33:17
The Gate of Yahweh	John 10:9 • Psalm 118:20 • Genesis 28:17
Life More Abundantly	John 10:10 • Psalm 36:8-9 • Deuteronomy 30:19-20
The Worthless Shepherd	John 10:12 • Zechariah 11:17 • Ezekiel 34:5-6
The Dedication of the Altar	John 10:22 • 2 Chronicles 7:9 • Numbers 7:84
You Are Gods	John 10:34 • Psalm 82:6 • Exodus 22:28
Scripture Cannot Be Broken	John 10:35 • Psalm 119:89 • Isaiah 40:8

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
Yahweh Is My Shepherd	John 10:11 • Psalm 23:1 • Isaiah 40:11
I Myself Will Shepherd My Sheep	John 10:11 • Ezekiel 34:11-12 • Ezekiel 34:15
Strike the Shepherd	John 10:15 • Zechariah 13:7 • Isaiah 53:6-7
One Flock, One Shepherd	John 10:16 • Ezekiel 37:22-24 • Ezekiel 34:23
No One Can Deliver Out of My Hand	John 10:28 • Isaiah 43:13 • Deuteronomy 32:39
I and the Father Are One	John 10:30 • Deuteronomy 6:4 • Zechariah 14:9
Set Apart and Sent	John 10:36 • Jeremiah 1:5 • Isaiah 61:1

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 10 Commentary (David Guzik) - the door of the sheep, the good shepherd, and the Feast of Dedication
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 10A - exposition of the good shepherd and his sheep

John 10 - Opening Intro

Chapter 10 picks up right where chapter 9 left off. A man just got thrown out of the synagogue for being healed. And Yahshua turns to the leaders who threw him out and starts talking about shepherds.

And every Jew listening knew what that meant, because the prophets had already said it. Ezekiel 34. Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves instead of the sheep. Jeremiah 23. Woe to the shepherds who scatter My flock.

So when He says the thief climbs over the wall instead of using the door - they know exactly who He is describing. They just threw a sheep over the wall.

Then He says: the shepherd calls his own sheep by name, and he goes out in front of them, and they follow him because they know his voice.

By name. And you know who else does that? Yahweh said to Moses, I know you by name. He said to Jacob, I have called you by your name - you are Mine.

And then two I AMs back to back. I am the door. I am the good shepherd.

Now the door - at night a shepherd would lead the sheep into a stone pen and then lie down across the opening himself. Nothing gets in or out except over him. He is not saying He opens the door. He is saying He is the door.

And then: the thief comes only to steal and kill and destroy. I came so that they could have life, and have it overflowing.

He did not come to keep you barely alive.

And then: I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.

Now go back to Ezekiel 34 for a minute, because this is where it gets beautiful. After God blasts the bad shepherds, He says - I Myself will search for My sheep. I Myself will be their shepherd. And then two verses later - I will set up one shepherd over them, My servant David.

Which is it? God Himself, or a son of David? And Yahshua stands up and says: yes. I am the good shepherd.

And He says the hired hand runs when the wolf comes, because they are not his sheep. You find out who owns the flock when it costs something.

And then: I have other sheep that are not of this fold. I must bring them too, and they will hear My voice, and there will be one flock and one shepherd.

Most people read that as the nations coming in, and they do come in. And Ezekiel 37 talks about the two sticks, Judah and Joseph, two houses made into one nation with one shepherd over them. However you read it, it ends the same - one flock, one shepherd.

And then He says the thing nobody else in history could say. Nobody takes My life from Me. I lay it down on My own. I have authority to lay it down and authority to take it back up again.

The cross did not happen to Him. He walked into it.

Then it is winter. The Feast of Dedication - remembering when the temple was cleansed after a pagan king had defiled it. And He is walking in Solomon's porch, and they surround Him. How long are You going to keep us hanging? If You are the Christ, tell us plainly.

And He says: I told you, and you do not believe. My sheep hear My voice, and I know them, and they follow Me. I give them eternal life. They will never perish. And nobody will snatch them out of My hand.

And then: nobody can snatch them out of My Father's hand.

My hand. The Father's hand. The same hand. And then He says it straight out. I and the Father are one.

And the stones come out again. Because, they say, You are a man and You are making Yourself God.

And He answers them from Psalm 82, where God calls the judges gods. If Scripture can call them that - and Scripture cannot be broken - how can you accuse the One the Father set apart and sent into the world of blasphemy for saying I am the Son of God?

Set apart - at the feast of setting apart. They were celebrating the rededication of an altar, and the One the Father consecrated was standing in front of them.

And He leaves, and goes back across the Jordan to where John used to baptize. And people come to Him there and say the best thing anybody could ever say about a preacher. John never did a single miracle. But everything John said about this man was true.

Before we read - ask yourself whose voice you actually follow. Not whose voice you agree with. Whose voice you follow.

John 10:1-42 (WEB)

1 "Most certainly, I tell you, one who doesn't enter by the door into the sheep fold, but climbs up some other way, the same is a thief and a robber.[1]

2 But one who enters in by the door is the shepherd of the sheep.

3 The gatekeeper opens the gate for him, and the sheep listen to his voice. He calls his own sheep by name, and leads them out.[2]

4 Whenever he brings out his own sheep, he goes before them, and the sheep follow him, for they know his voice.

5 They will by no means follow a stranger, but will flee from him; for they don't know the voice of strangers."

6 Jesus spoke this parable to them, but they didn't understand what he was telling them.

---

[1] **Cross-Reference:** Ezekiel 34:2-3 • Jeremiah 23:1-2 - *woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves and not the sheep, and who scatter the flock of my pasture*

[2] **Cross-Reference:** Isaiah 43:1 • Exodus 33:17 - *I have called you by your name, you are mine, and I know you by name*

7 Jesus therefore said to them again, “Most certainly, I tell you, I am the sheep’s door.

8 All who came before me are thieves and robbers, but the sheep didn’t listen to them.

9 I am the door. If anyone enters in by me, he will be saved, and will go in and go out, and will find pasture.[3]

10 The thief only comes to steal, kill, and destroy. I came that they may have life, and may have it abundantly.[4]

11 I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.[5]

12 He who is a hired hand, and not a shepherd, who doesn’t own the sheep, sees the wolf coming, leaves the sheep, and flees. The wolf snatches the sheep, and scatters them.[6]

13 The hired hand flees because he is a hired hand, and doesn’t care for the sheep.

14 I am the good shepherd. I know my own, and I’m known by my own;

15 even as the Father knows me, and I know the Father. I lay down my life for the sheep.[7]

16 I have other sheep, which are not of this fold. I must bring them also, and they will hear my voice. They will become one flock with one shepherd.[8]

17 Therefore the Father loves me, because I lay down my life, that I may take it again.

18 No one takes it away from me, but I lay it down by myself. I have power to lay it down, and I have power to take it again. I received this commandment from my Father.”

19 Therefore a division arose again among the Jews because of these words.

20 Many of them said, “He has a demon, and is insane! Why do you listen to him?”

21 Others said, “These are not the sayings of one possessed by a demon. It isn’t possible for a demon to open the eyes of the blind, is it?”

22 It was the Feast of the Dedication at Jerusalem.[9]

---

[3] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 118:20 • Genesis 28:17 - *this is the gate of Yahweh, the righteous will enter it, and Jacob’s house of God and gate of heaven*

[4] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 36:8-9 • Deuteronomy 30:19-20 - *abundantly satisfied with the abundance of your house, with you the spring of life, and choose life, for he is your life*

[5] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 23:1 • Ezekiel 34:15 - *Yahweh is my shepherd, I shall lack nothing, and I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep*

[6] **Cross-Reference:** Zechariah 11:17 • Ezekiel 34:5-6 - *woe to the worthless shepherd who leaves the flock, and sheep scattered with no one to search or seek*

[7] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 13:7 • Isaiah 53:6-7 - *strike the shepherd and the sheep will be scattered, and the iniquity of us all laid on him who was led as a lamb*

[8] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:22-24 • Ezekiel 34:23 - *the two kingdoms made one nation with one king and one shepherd, and one shepherd set over them, my servant David*

23 It was winter, and Jesus was walking in the temple, in Solomon's porch.

24 The Jews therefore came around him and said to him, "How long will you hold us in suspense? If you are the Christ, tell us plainly."

25 Jesus answered them, "I told you, and you don't believe. The works that I do in my Father's name, these testify about me.

26 But you don't believe, because you are not of my sheep, as I told you.

27 My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me.

28 I give eternal life to them. They will never perish, and no one will snatch them out of my hand.[10]

29 My Father, who has given them to me, is greater than all. No one is able to snatch them out of my Father's hand.

30 I and the Father are one."[11]

31 Therefore Jews took up stones again to stone him.

32 Jesus answered them, "I have shown you many good works from my Father. For which of those works do you stone me?"

33 The Jews answered him, "We don't stone you for a good work, but for blasphemy: because you, being a man, make yourself God."

34 Jesus answered them, "Isn't it written in your law, 'I said, you are gods?'[12]

35 If he called them gods, to whom the word of God came (and the Scripture can't be broken),[13]

36 do you say of him whom the Father sanctified and sent into the world, 'You blaspheme,' because I said, 'I am the Son of God?'[14]

37 If I don't do the works of my Father, don't believe me.

38 But if I do them, though you don't believe me, believe the works; that you may know and believe that the Father is in me, and I in the Father."

---

[9] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Chronicles 7:9 • Numbers 7:84 - *the dedication of the altar kept seven days in Solomon's temple, and the altar's dedication in the wilderness*

[10] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 43:13 • Deuteronomy 32:39 - *no one can deliver out of my hand, I am he*

[11] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 6:4 • Zechariah 14:9 - *hear, Israel, Yahweh is one, and in that day Yahweh will be one and his name one*

[12] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 82:6 • Exodus 22:28 - *I said, you are gods, all of you sons of the Most High, and you shall not blaspheme God nor curse a ruler*

[13] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 119:89 • Isaiah 40:8 - *your word is settled in heaven forever, and the word of our God stands forever*

[14] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Jeremiah 1:5 • Isaiah 61:1 - *before you were born I sanctified you, and the Spirit of the Lord Yahweh on the one he anointed and sent*

39 They sought again to seize him, and he went out of their hand.

40 He went away again beyond the Jordan into the place where John was baptizing at first, and there he stayed.

41 Many came to him. They said, “John indeed did no sign, but everything that John said about this man is true.”

42 Many believed in him there.

CHAPTER 11 - Two Days' Delay, I Am the Resurrection, and Lazarus, Come Out

Key Notes

- Bethany was a village on the far side of the Mount of Olives, fifteen stadia - under two miles - from Jerusalem. Close enough to be dangerous (John 11:1, 11:18).
- John identifies Mary as the one who anointed the Lord, though he does not tell that story until the next chapter. He assumes his readers already know it (John 11:2, 12:3).
- "Lord, behold, he for whom you have great affection is sick." The sisters send no request. They send a description of the need and trust the love (John 11:3).
- "This sickness is not to death" - and Lazarus dies. He means death will not be the end of it (John 11:4).
- "Now Jesus loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus. When therefore he heard that he was sick, he stayed two days." John puts the love and the delay side by side with the word therefore between them. The delay was not the opposite of the love (John 11:5-6).
- The disciples remind Him that the Judeans just tried to stone Him. Going to Bethany means going back into range (John 11:8, 10:31).
- "Aren't there twelve hours of daylight?" A man walking in the day does not stumble. His day had a set length, and nothing could cut it short (John 11:9-10).
- "Our friend Lazarus has fallen asleep." Scripture often calls death sleep, as Daniel speaks of those who sleep in the dust of the earth awakening. The disciples take Him literally, and He has to say it plainly: Lazarus is dead (John 11:11-14, Daniel 12:2).
- "Let's go also, that we may die with him." Thomas, remembered for doubting, is the one who says this. Courage and doubt can live in the same man (John 11:16).
- Lazarus had been in the tomb four days. There was a popular belief that the soul lingered near the body for three days. On the fourth day nobody could pretend he was not really dead (John 11:17, 11:39).
- Many had come from Jerusalem to console the sisters. Mourning was public and lasted days, which means the miracle that follows will have a large audience (John 11:19, 11:45).
- Martha goes out to meet Him; Mary sits in the house. The same two women as in Luke, behaving exactly as they did there (John 11:20, Luke 10:39-40).
- "I know that he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day." Martha's theology is correct, and it is the theology of Daniel 12. She believed in a resurrection someday. He is about to show her that someday is standing in front of her (John 11:24).
- "I am the resurrection and the life" is the fifth of the seven I AM sayings with a picture. He does not say I will bring the resurrection. He says I am it (John 11:25).

- “Do you believe this?” Martha’s answer - You are the Christ, the Son of God, he who comes into the world - is almost word for word the purpose statement of the whole Gospel (John 11:27, 20:31).
- Mary says exactly what Martha said: Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn’t have died. To Martha He gave theology. To Mary He gives tears. Same sentence, different need (John 11:21, 11:32).
- “He groaned in the spirit, and was troubled.” The word for groaned can describe a horse snorting, and in Greek it carries anger. He was not only sad. He was angry at death itself (John 11:33, 11:38).
- “Jesus wept” is the shortest verse in the English Bible. The word is different from the loud wailing of the mourners around Him. These were quiet tears, from a man who knew He was about to fix it (John 11:35).
- “Lord, by this time there is a stench, for he has been dead four days.” Martha, who said she believed, still tries to stop Him at the stone. Believing in theory and believing at the tomb are different things (John 11:39).
- He prays out loud, and says why: for the sake of the crowd, that they may believe the Father sent Him. He thanks the Father before anything has happened (John 11:41-42).
- “Lazarus, come out!” He calls him by name. Some have said that if He had not named him, every grave in the place would have emptied. It is a preview of the hour when all who are in the tombs will hear His voice (John 11:43, 5:28).
- Lazarus comes out still bound, hands and feet, his face wrapped. Yahshua gives life; the people standing there are told to unwrap him. Loose him, and let him go (John 11:44).
- Lazarus would die again. This is a raising, not yet the resurrection. The grave clothes stay behind in the tomb only when Yahshua Himself rises (John 11:44, 20:6-7).
- The council meets because the miracle is too big to ignore. Their fear is that the Romans will take away both our place and our nation. The place means the temple. Forty years later the Romans did exactly that (John 11:47-48, Jeremiah 7:14).
- Caiaphas was high priest that year, and says one man should die for the people rather than the whole nation perish. He meant it as cold politics. John says he was prophesying, because of his office, and did not know it (John 11:49-51).
- “Not for the nation only, but that he might also gather together into one the children of God who are scattered abroad.” The language of gathering the scattered is the prophets’ language for the regathering of Israel, and of the nations with them (John 11:52, Ezekiel 37:21, Isaiah 11:12).
- From that day they plotted to kill Him. Raising a dead man is what finally got Him killed (John 11:53).
- He withdrew to a town called Ephraim, near the wilderness. It is the only time John mentions it (John 11:54).

- Many went up to Jerusalem before the Passover to purify themselves, since anyone unclean could not eat it. The Torah made provision for those who could not keep it at the first time (John 11:55, Numbers 9:10).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
Twelve Hours in the Day	John 11:9 • Psalm 121:6 • Proverbs 4:18
Fallen Asleep	John 11:11 • Daniel 12:2 • Psalm 13:3
The Resurrection at the Last Day	John 11:24 • Job 19:25-26 • Isaiah 26:19
Tears in His Bottle	John 11:35 • Psalm 56:8 • Isaiah 53:3
Loose Him	John 11:44 • Psalm 116:16 • Isaiah 61:1
Our Place and Our Nation	John 11:48 • Jeremiah 7:4 • Jeremiah 7:14
Purified Before the Passover	John 11:55 • Numbers 9:10 • 2 Chronicles 30:17-18

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
I Am the Resurrection	John 11:25 • Hosea 13:14 • Isaiah 25:8
The Son Who Comes Into the World	John 11:27 • Psalm 2:7 • Psalm 118:26
I Will Open Your Graves	John 11:43 • Ezekiel 37:12-13 • 1 Samuel 2:6
One Man for the People	John 11:50 • Isaiah 53:8 • Daniel 9:26
A High Priest Who Spoke for God	John 11:51 • Numbers 27:21 • Exodus 28:30
Gathering the Scattered Into One	John 11:52 • Ezekiel 37:21-22 • Isaiah 11:12

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 11 Commentary (David Guzik) - the death and raising of Lazarus and the council's plot
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 11A - exposition of the raising of Lazarus

John 11 - Opening Intro

This chapter starts with a message. Two sisters in Bethany send word to Yahshua: Lord, the one You love is sick.

And notice what they do not say. They do not say come quick. They do not tell Him what to do. They just tell Him who is sick and trust that the love will do the rest.

And then John writes the two sentences that have puzzled people for two thousand years. Jesus loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus. So when He heard he was sick, He stayed where He was two more days.

So. He loved them, so He waited.

Some of you are in a two-day delay right now. And you have been reading it as proof that He does not care. John puts the love and the waiting side by side and connects them with the word so. The delay was not the opposite of the love.

Then He says: let us go back to Judea. And the disciples say: they just tried to stone You there. And Thomas - the one everybody remembers for doubting - says: let us go too, so we can die with Him. Courage and doubt can live in the same man.

He tells them Lazarus has fallen asleep. And they say: great, if he is sleeping he will get better. So He says it plain. Lazarus is dead.

By the time they get to Bethany, Lazarus has been in the tomb four days. Four. Nobody can say he was just unconscious. He is gone.

And Martha hears He is coming and goes out to meet Him on the road. And the first thing she says is: Lord, if You had been here, my brother would not have died.

Then she says: but even now I know whatever You ask God, He will give You.

And He says: your brother will rise again.

And she says: I know. In the resurrection at the last day. That is good theology. That is Daniel 12. She believes in a resurrection someday.

And He says: I am the resurrection and the life. He who believes in Me, though he dies, yet will he live. Do you believe this?

He did not say I will bring the resurrection. He said I am the resurrection. Someday was standing on the road in front of her.

And Martha says: yes, Lord. I believe You are the Christ, the Son of God, the One coming into the world. Which is almost word for word why John says he wrote this whole book.

Then Mary comes. And she falls at His feet and says the exact same sentence her sister said. Lord, if You had been here, my brother would not have died.

Same words. And He does not give Mary the theology He gave Martha. Martha needed truth. Mary needed Him to feel it. He knows which one you need.

And He sees her weeping, and the crowd weeping, and John says He groaned in His spirit and was troubled. That word groaned - in Greek it has anger in it. Like a horse snorting. He was not just sad. He was angry. At death. At what it does to the people He loves.

And He says: where have you laid him? And they say: come and see.

Remember that phrase from chapter 1? Come and see. Those were the words of an invitation to life. Now they are leading Him to a grave.

And then the shortest verse in the English Bible. Jesus wept.

He knew. He knew in ten minutes Lazarus would be standing there alive. And He wept anyway.

That tells you He does not skip your grief to get to the fix.

He goes to the tomb - a cave with a stone across it - and says: take away the stone.

And Martha - the one who just said I believe - says: Lord, it has been four days. He stinks.

Believing in the resurrection on the road is one thing. Believing at the stone is another.

They roll it away. He lifts up His eyes and thanks the Father - before anything has happened. And then He shouts with a loud voice: Lazarus, come out!

Somebody once said that if He had not said Lazarus by name, every grave in that place would have emptied. He said in chapter 5 that the hour is coming when all who are in the tombs will hear His voice. This was a preview.

And the dead man comes out. Still wrapped. Hands and feet bound, face covered with a cloth.

And Yahshua turns to the people standing there and says: loose him, and let him go.

He gave the life. He told them to take off the grave clothes. Some of you have been raised, and you are still walking around wrapped in what you wore in the tomb. He is telling the people around you to help you get loose.

And then the turn. Some of the crowd believe. Some go and report Him. And the council meets. If we let Him go on, everybody will believe in Him, and the Romans will come and take away our place and our nation.

And Caiaphas the high priest says: you know nothing. It is better for one man to die for the people than for the whole nation to perish.

He meant it as politics. Kill one man, keep the peace. And John says - he did not say this on his own. Being high priest that year, he prophesied that Jesus would die for the nation. And not for the nation only, but to gather into one all the children of God scattered around the world.

The most important prophecy in the chapter came out of the mouth of a man trying to kill Him.

Before we read - notice that the greatest miracle He did before the cross was the one that sent Him to the cross. He gave Lazarus his life, and it cost Him His.

John 11:1-57 (WEB)

1 Now a certain man was sick, Lazarus from Bethany, of the village of Mary and her sister, Martha.

2 It was that Mary who had anointed the Lord with ointment, and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother, Lazarus, was sick.

3 The sisters therefore sent to him, saying, "Lord, behold, he for whom you have great affection is sick."

4 But when Jesus heard it, he said, "This sickness is not to death, but for the glory of God, that God's Son may be glorified by it."

5 Now Jesus loved Martha, and her sister, and Lazarus.

6 When therefore he heard that he was sick, he stayed two days in the place where he was.

7 Then after this he said to the disciples, "Let's go into Judea again."

8 The disciples told him, "Rabbi, the Jews were just trying to stone you, and are you going there again?"

9 Jesus answered, "Aren't there twelve hours of daylight? If a man walks in the day, he doesn't stumble, because he sees the light of this world.[15]

10 But if a man walks in the night, he stumbles, because the light isn't in him."

11 He said these things, and after that, he said to them, "Our friend, Lazarus, has fallen asleep, but I am going so that I may awake him out of sleep."[16]

12 The disciples therefore said, "Lord, if he has fallen asleep, he will recover."

13 Now Jesus had spoken of his death, but they thought that he spoke of taking rest in sleep.

14 So Jesus said to them plainly then, "Lazarus is dead.

15 I am glad for your sakes that I was not there, so that you may believe. Nevertheless, let's go to him."

16 Thomas therefore, who is called Didymus, said to his fellow disciples, "Let's go also, that we may die with him."

17 So when Jesus came, he found that he had been in the tomb four days already.

18 Now Bethany was near Jerusalem, about fifteen stadia away.

---

[15] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 121:6 • Proverbs 4:18 - *the sun will not harm you by day, and the path of the righteous shining more and more until the perfect day*

[16] **Cross-Reference:** Daniel 12:2 • Psalm 13:3 - *many who sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, and give light to my eyes lest I sleep in death*

19 Many of the Jews had joined the women around Martha and Mary, to console them concerning their brother.

20 Then when Martha heard that Jesus was coming, she went and met him, but Mary stayed in the house.

21 Therefore Martha said to Jesus, “Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn’t have died.

22 Even now I know that, whatever you ask of God, God will give you.”

23 Jesus said to her, “Your brother will rise again.”

24 Martha said to him, “I know that he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day.”[17]

25 Jesus said to her, “I am the resurrection and the life. He who believes in me will still live, even if he dies.[18]

26 Whoever lives and believes in me will never die. Do you believe this?”

27 She said to him, “Yes, Lord. I have come to believe that you are the Christ, God’s Son, he who comes into the world.”[19]

28 When she had said this, she went away, and called Mary, her sister, secretly, saying, “The Teacher is here, and is calling you.”

29 When she heard this, she arose quickly, and went to him.

30 Now Jesus had not yet come into the village, but was in the place where Martha met him.

31 Then the Jews who were with her in the house, and were consoling her, when they saw Mary, that she rose up quickly and went out, followed her, saying, “She is going to the tomb to weep there.”

32 Therefore when Mary came to where Jesus was, and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying to him, “Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn’t have died.”

33 When Jesus therefore saw her weeping, and the Jews weeping who came with her, he groaned in the spirit, and was troubled,

34 and said, “Where have you laid him?” They told him, “Lord, come and see.”

35 Jesus wept.[20]

---

[17] **Cross-Reference:** Job 19:25-26 • Isaiah 26:19 - *my Redeemer standing on the earth at the last and seen in my flesh, and your dead shall live and arise*

[18] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Hosea 13:14 • Isaiah 25:8 - *I will ransom them from the power of Sheol and redeem them from death, and he has swallowed up death forever*

[19] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 2:7 • Psalm 118:26 - *you are my son, today I have become your father, and blessed is he who comes in Yahweh’s name*

[20] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 56:8 • Isaiah 53:3 - *you put my tears into your bottle, and a man of suffering, acquainted with grief*

36 The Jews therefore said, “See how much affection he had for him!”

37 Some of them said, “Couldn’t this man, who opened the eyes of him who was blind, have also kept this man from dying?”

38 Jesus therefore, again groaning in himself, came to the tomb. Now it was a cave, and a stone lay against it.

39 Jesus said, “Take away the stone.” Martha, the sister of him who was dead, said to him, “Lord, by this time there is a stench, for he has been dead four days.”

40 Jesus said to her, “Didn’t I tell you that if you believed, you would see God’s glory?”

41 So they took away the stone from the place where the dead man was lying. Jesus lifted up his eyes, and said, “Father, I thank you that you listened to me.

42 I know that you always listen to me, but because of the multitude standing around I said this, that they may believe that you sent me.”

43 When he had said this, he cried with a loud voice, “Lazarus, come out!”[21]

44 He who was dead came out, bound hand and foot with wrappings, and his face was wrapped around with a cloth. Jesus said to them, “Free him, and let him go.”[22]

45 Therefore many of the Jews, who came to Mary and saw what Jesus did, believed in him.

46 But some of them went away to the Pharisees, and told them the things which Jesus had done.

47 The chief priests therefore and the Pharisees gathered a council, and said, “What are we doing? For this man does many signs.

48 If we leave him alone like this, everyone will believe in him, and the Romans will come and take away both our place and our nation.”[23]

49 But a certain one of them, Caiaphas, being high priest that year, said to them, “You know nothing at all,

50 nor do you consider that it is advantageous for us that one man should die for the people, and that the whole nation not perish.”[24]

---

[21] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:12-13 • 1 Samuel 2:6 - *I will open your graves and cause you to come up out of them, and Yahweh kills and makes alive*

[22] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 116:16 • Isaiah 61:1 - *you have freed me from my chains, and the opening of the prison to those who are bound*

[23] **Cross-Reference:** Jeremiah 7:4 • Jeremiah 7:14 - *do not trust in lying words, the temple of Yahweh, and I will do to this house as I did to Shiloh*

[24] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:8 • Daniel 9:26 - *cut off out of the land of the living for the disobedience of my people, and the Anointed One cut off*

51 Now he didn't say this of himself, but being high priest that year, he prophesied that Jesus would die for the nation,[25]

52 and not for the nation only, but that he might also gather together into one the children of God who are scattered abroad.[26]

53 So from that day forward they took counsel that they might put him to death.

54 Jesus therefore walked no more openly among the Jews, but departed from there into the country near the wilderness, to a city called Ephraim. He stayed there with his disciples.

55 Now the Passover of the Jews was at hand. Many went up from the country to Jerusalem before the Passover, to purify themselves.[27]

56 Then they sought for Jesus and spoke one with another, as they stood in the temple, "What do you think—that he isn't coming to the feast at all?"

57 Now the chief priests and the Pharisees had commanded that if anyone knew where he was, he should report it, that they might seize him.

---

[25] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Numbers 27:21 • Exodus 28:30 - *the priest inquiring by the judgment of the Urim before Yahweh, and the high priest bearing the judgment of Israel on his heart*

[26] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Ezekiel 37:21-22 • Isaiah 11:12 - *the children of Israel gathered from among the nations and made one nation, and the outcasts of Israel and the dispersed of Judah assembled*

[27] **Cross-Reference:** Numbers 9:10 • 2 Chronicles 30:17-18 - *the Passover still kept by one unclean or far away, and Hezekiah praying for those who ate it uncleansed*

CHAPTER 12 - A Pound of Nard, a King on a Donkey's Colt, and Isaiah Saw His Glory

Key Notes

- "Six days before the Passover" begins the final week. From here, John slows down; the last third of his Gospel covers only a few days (John 12:1).
- Martha served, Lazarus reclined at the table, and Mary poured. Three people, three ways of loving Him, none of them wrong (John 12:2-3).
- A pound, litra, was about eleven ounces of pure nard - a perfume made from a plant that grew in the Himalayas. Judas priced it at three hundred denarii, about a year's wages for a laborer (John 12:3, 12:5).
- Mark and Matthew say she poured it on His head. John says His feet. A pound of perfume is enough for both. Kings were anointed on the head; feet were the place a servant knelt (John 12:3, Mark 14:3).
- She wiped His feet with her hair. A respectable woman did not let her hair down in front of men. She did not care what it cost her (John 12:3).
- "The house was filled with the fragrance." The Song of Songs: while the king sat at his table, my perfume spread its fragrance. Everyone who left that house smelled of it (John 12:3, Song of Solomon 1:12).
- Judas objects on behalf of the poor. John tells us he did not care about the poor; he kept the money box and stole from it. The loudest objection to extravagant worship came from the thief (John 12:4-6).
- "She has kept this for the day of my burial." She may have understood what the twelve kept refusing to hear (John 12:7).
- "You always have the poor with you" is Deuteronomy 15, which goes on: therefore open your hand wide to the poor. It is not permission to ignore them. It is a reminder that the chance to anoint Him was almost over (John 12:8, Deuteronomy 15:11).
- The chief priests plot to kill Lazarus too, because he is evidence. A living man who had been dead four days was very bad for their case (John 12:10-11).
- Palm branches are the branches of Tabernacles, commanded in Leviticus 23 for rejoicing before Yahweh, and they had become a symbol of national victory. The crowd is waving a feast and a liberation at the same time (John 12:13, Leviticus 23:40).
- "Hosanna" is Hebrew for save now, from Psalm 118, one of the psalms sung at the feasts. Blessed is he who comes in the name of Yahweh is the next verse (John 12:13, Psalm 118:25-26).
- "The King of Israel" is what Nathanael called Him in chapter 1. Now a whole city says it - and in a few days a sign over His head will say it in three languages (John 12:13, 1:49, 19:19).

- He rides a young donkey, as Zechariah said - lowly, not on a warhorse. John opens the quotation with don't be afraid, daughter of Zion, words that echo Zephaniah (John 12:14-15, Zechariah 9:9, Zephaniah 3:16).
- "His disciples didn't understand these things at first." John admits they missed it, and only connected the Scripture to the event after He was glorified (John 12:16).
- "Look, the world has gone after him." They meant everyone. Two verses later the world arrives, in the form of Greeks (John 12:19-20).
- The Greeks come to Philip, who has a Greek name and was from Bethsaida in Galilee. Philip goes to Andrew, and the two of them go to Yahshua. The same two men who brought people to Him in chapter 1 (John 12:21-22, 1:43-45).
- "The time has come for the Son of Man to be glorified." The hour that was not yet at Cana has arrived. And glorified, in this Gospel, means the cross (John 12:23, 2:4).
- A grain of wheat that falls into the ground and dies bears much fruit. The day after the Sabbath during Unleavened Bread, the first sheaf of the harvest was waved before Yahweh - the firstfruits of what had been buried and come up (John 12:24, Leviticus 23:10-11).
- "He who loves his life will lose it. He who hates his life in this world will keep it." Hate is the Hebrew way of saying love less by comparison. It is about which life you are holding onto (John 12:25).
- "Now my soul is troubled." This is John's Gethsemane. He asks out loud whether to pray to be saved from this hour, and answers Himself: no, for this cause I came to this hour (John 12:27).
- A voice from heaven answers. Some heard thunder. Some said an angel spoke. The same sound, heard three ways, depending on the hearer (John 12:28-29).
- "Now the prince of this world will be cast out." The cross looked like the defeat of Yahshua. It was the defeat of the one who held the world (John 12:31, Luke 10:18).
- "If I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to myself." Lifted up is the word from chapter 3 and chapter 8, and John explains it means the kind of death He would die (John 12:32-33, 3:14, 8:28).
- "We have heard out of the law that the Christ remains forever." They are right - the throne of David's son is forever. What they cannot fit is a Christ who dies first (John 12:34, Psalm 89:36).
- Isaiah 53:1 - who has believed our report - opens the suffering servant passage, and John quotes it over the end of the public ministry. The signs were done, and they still did not believe (John 12:37-38, Isaiah 53:1).
- "Isaiah said these things when he saw his glory, and spoke of him." The glory Isaiah saw was the Lord on the throne, high and lifted up, with the seraphim crying holy, holy, holy, Yahweh of Armies. John says that was Yahshua (John 12:41, Isaiah 6:1-3).
- "High and lifted up" in Isaiah 6 is the same pair of words Isaiah uses for the suffering servant in chapter 52: exalted and lifted up, and very high. The throne and the cross are described in the same language (John 12:41, Isaiah 6:1, 52:13).

- Many of the rulers believed in Him but would not confess it, for fear of being put out of the synagogue. They loved the praise of men more than the praise of God. Belief that will not be seen is a kind of fear (John 12:42-43).
- “He who believes in me, believes not in me, but in him who sent me.” To see Him is to see the Father (John 12:44-45, 14:9).
- “The word that I spoke, the same will judge him in the last day.” The promise of Deuteronomy 18: whoever will not listen to my words, which the prophet speaks in my name, I will require it of him (John 12:48, Deuteronomy 18:19).
- “I know that his commandment is eternal life.” The public ministry ends on the Father’s commandment, and calls it life (John 12:50).

Key Cross-References (WEB)

Topic	References
My Perfume Spread Its Fragrance	John 12:3 • Song of Solomon 1:12 • Song of Solomon 4:14
Spices for a Burial	John 12:7 • 2 Chronicles 16:14
The Poor Will Never Cease	John 12:8 • Deuteronomy 15:11
Branches of Palm Trees	John 12:13 • Leviticus 23:40 • Nehemiah 8:15
Firstfruits of the Harvest	John 12:24 • Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:36-37
The Prince of This World Cast Out	John 12:31 • Luke 10:18
The Throne That Remains Forever	John 12:34 • Psalm 89:36-37 • Isaiah 9:7
The Fear of Man	John 12:43 • Proverbs 29:25 • 1 Samuel 15:24

Prophecy Fulfilled

Fulfillment	References
Hosanna, Blessed Is He Who Comes	John 12:13 • Psalm 118:25-26
Your King Comes on a Donkey’s Colt	John 12:15 • Zechariah 9:9 • Zephaniah 3:16
Lifted Up to Draw All People	John 12:32 • Isaiah 52:13 • Isaiah 11:10
Who Has Believed Our Report?	John 12:38 • Isaiah 53:1
Eyes Shut, Hearts Made Fat	John 12:40 • Isaiah 6:10
Isaiah Saw His Glory	John 12:41 • Isaiah 6:1-3 • Isaiah 52:13
The Words the Father Commanded	John 12:49 • Deuteronomy 18:18-19

For Further Study

Credible external commentary that expounds on this chapter in a way consistent with a Torah-honoring, Messianic reading of the text:

- Enduring Word - John 12 Commentary (David Guzik) - the anointing at Bethany, the triumphal entry, and the grain of wheat
- Life, Hope and Truth - The Gospel of John - John's signs, the I AM sayings, and why this Gospel differs from the other three
- Verse By Verse Ministry International - The Gospel of John, Lesson 12A - exposition of the anointing and the entry into Jerusalem

John 12 - Opening Intro

Six days before Passover. The last week begins.

And it begins at a dinner table in Bethany. Martha is serving - of course she is. Lazarus is reclining at the table - the man who was dead, eating dinner. And Mary walks in with a pound of pure nard.

Now this is not a little bottle of perfume. A pound of it. Judas does the math later: three hundred denarii. That is a year's wages. That might have been everything she had.

And she pours it on His feet. And then she lets her hair down - which a respectable woman did not do in front of men - and wipes His feet with her hair.

She did not care what it cost. Not the money. Not her reputation.

And John says the whole house was filled with the smell of it. Everybody who walked out of that house that night smelled like her worship.

And then Judas speaks up. Why was this not sold and given to the poor?

Sounds spiritual, does it not? And John tells us the truth: he did not care about the poor. He kept the money bag, and he was stealing from it.

The loudest objection to extravagant worship came from the thief.

And Yahshua says: leave her alone. She kept this for the day of My burial.

She may have been the only one in the room who was listening when He said He was going to die.

Next day, the crowd hears He is coming to Jerusalem, and they cut palm branches and go out to meet Him shouting Hosanna.

Now palm branches - those are the branches from Leviticus 23, the ones you take at Sukkot to rejoice before Yahweh. And Hosanna is Psalm 118 - save us now. Blessed is He who comes in the name of Yahweh. They are throwing a feast in the middle of the road.

And He comes in riding a young donkey. Not a warhorse. A donkey. Because Zechariah said: your King comes to you, lowly, riding on a donkey, on a colt.

And John admits the disciples did not get it. Not until after He was glorified did they remember that this was written about Him.

Then some Greeks come up to Philip and say: Sir, we want to see Jesus.

And Philip goes and tells Andrew, and Andrew and Philip go tell Yahshua. And you would think He would say: great, bring them in. Instead He says: the hour has come.

Remember at the wedding in Cana? My hour has not yet come. It just came.

And He says: unless a grain of wheat falls into the ground and dies, it stays alone. But if it dies, it bears much fruit.

The Greeks want to see Him. And He says: you will see Me when I am buried like a seed and come up as a harvest. During Unleavened Bread the very first sheaf of the harvest was waved before Yahweh. Firstfruits. That is what He is about to become.

And then He lets us see His heart. Now My soul is troubled. What should I say - Father, save Me from this hour? No. This is why I came. Father, glorify Your name.

That is John's Gethsemane.

And a voice answers from heaven: I have glorified it, and I will glorify it again. And some people say it thundered. Some say an angel talked to Him. Same sound. Three different reactions. Some of you hear God and call it weather.

And He says: now is the judgment of this world. Now the prince of this world will be thrown out. And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to Myself.

And John tells us what lifted up means. The kind of death He was going to die.

And then John does something. He closes the curtain on the public ministry with Isaiah. Lord, who has believed our report? Even after all those signs, they did not believe.

And then he quotes Isaiah 6. He blinded their eyes. And then he says the sentence I want you to underline.

Isaiah said these things when he saw His glory, and spoke of Him.

Go back to Isaiah 6. What did Isaiah see? The Lord sitting on a throne, high and lifted up. The seraphim crying holy, holy, holy is Yahweh of Armies. The whole earth is full of His glory.

And John says: that was Him. Isaiah saw Yahshua on the throne.

And here is the thing - Isaiah uses those same words, high and lifted up, for the suffering servant. Isaiah 52:13. Behold, my servant will be exalted and lifted up, and very high. And then the very next verses are about His face being marred more than any man's.

The throne and the cross. Same words. Same Person.

And John ends with this: many of the rulers actually believed in Him. But they would not say so, because they were afraid of getting thrown out. They loved the praise of men more than the praise of God.

Before we read - Mary poured out everything in front of everybody, and the rulers kept everything hidden to protect themselves. One of them filled a house with fragrance. Which one are you?

John 12:1-50 (WEB)

1 Then six days before the Passover, Jesus came to Bethany, where Lazarus was, who had been dead, whom he raised from the dead.

2 So they made him a supper there. Martha served, but Lazarus was one of those who sat at the table with him.

3 Mary, therefore, took a pound of ointment of pure nard, very precious, and anointed the feet of Jesus, and wiped his feet with her hair. The house was filled with the fragrance of the ointment.[28]

4 Then Judas Iscariot, Simon's son, one of his disciples, who would betray him, said,

5 "Why wasn't this ointment sold for three hundred denarii, and given to the poor?"

6 Now he said this, not because he cared for the poor, but because he was a thief, and having the money box, used to steal what was put into it.

7 But Jesus said, "Leave her alone. She has kept this for the day of my burial.[29]

8 For you always have the poor with you, but you don't always have me."[30]

9 A large crowd therefore of the Jews learned that he was there, and they came, not for Jesus' sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead.

10 But the chief priests conspired to put Lazarus to death also,

11 because on account of him many of the Jews went away and believed in Jesus.

12 On the next day a great multitude had come to the feast. When they heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem,

13 they took the branches of the palm trees, and went out to meet him, and cried out, "Hosanna! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord, the King of Israel!"[31,32]

14 Jesus, having found a young donkey, sat on it. As it is written,

---

[28] **Cross-Reference:** Song of Solomon 1:12 • Song of Solomon 4:14 - *while the king sat at his table my perfume spread its fragrance, and spikenard among all the best spices*

[29] **Cross-Reference:** 2 Chronicles 16:14 - *a king laid in a bed filled with sweet odors and spices prepared by the perfumers' art*

[30] **Cross-Reference:** Deuteronomy 15:11 - *the poor will never cease out of the land, therefore open your hand to your needy and your poor*

[31] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Psalm 118:25-26 - *save us now, Yahweh, and blessed is he who comes in Yahweh's name*

[32] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:40 • Nehemiah 8:15 - *branches of palm trees taken to rejoice before Yahweh seven days, and palm branches gathered to make shelters*

15 “Don’t be afraid, daughter of Zion. Behold, your King comes, sitting on a donkey’s colt.”[33]

16 His disciples didn’t understand these things at first, but when Jesus was glorified, then they remembered that these things were written about him, and that they had done these things to him.

17 The multitude therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus out of the tomb, and raised him from the dead, was testifying about it.

18 For this cause also the multitude went and met him, because they heard that he had done this sign.

19 The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, “See how you accomplish nothing. Behold, the world has gone after him.”

20 Now there were certain Greeks among those that went up to worship at the feast.

21 These, therefore, came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida of Galilee, and asked him, saying, “Sir, we want to see Jesus.”

22 Philip came and told Andrew, and in turn, Andrew came with Philip, and they told Jesus.

23 Jesus answered them, “The time has come for the Son of Man to be glorified.

24 Most certainly I tell you, unless a grain of wheat falls into the earth and dies, it remains by itself alone. But if it dies, it bears much fruit.[34]

25 He who loves his life will lose it. He who hates his life in this world will keep it to eternal life.

26 If anyone serves me, let him follow me. Where I am, there will my servant also be. If anyone serves me, the Father will honor him.

27 “Now my soul is troubled. What shall I say? ‘Father, save me from this time?’ But for this cause I came to this time.

28 Father, glorify your name!” Then there came a voice out of the sky, saying, “I have both glorified it, and will glorify it again.”

29 The multitude therefore, who stood by and heard it, said that it had thundered. Others said, “An angel has spoken to him.”

30 Jesus answered, “This voice hasn’t come for my sake, but for your sakes.

31 Now is the judgment of this world. Now the prince of this world will be cast out.[35]

32 And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all people to myself.”[36]

---

[33] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Zechariah 9:9 • Zephaniah 3:16 - *your King comes to you, lowly and riding on a colt, the foal of a donkey, and do not be afraid, Zion*

[34] **Cross-Reference:** Leviticus 23:10-11 • 1 Corinthians 15:36-37 - *the sheaf of the firstfruits waved before Yahweh, and what you sow is not made alive unless it dies*

[35] **Cross-Reference:** Luke 10:18 - *I saw Satan having fallen like lightning from heaven*

33 But he said this, signifying by what kind of death he should die.

34 The multitude answered him, “We have heard out of the law that the Christ remains forever. How do you say, ‘The Son of Man must be lifted up?’ Who is this Son of Man?”[37]

35 Jesus therefore said to them, “Yet a little while the light is with you. Walk while you have the light, that darkness doesn’t overtake you. He who walks in the darkness doesn’t know where he is going.

36 While you have the light, believe in the light, that you may become children of light.” Jesus said these things, and he departed and hid himself from them.

37 But though he had done so many signs before them, yet they didn’t believe in him,

38 that the word of Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled, which he spoke, “Lord, who has believed our report? To whom has the arm of the Lord been revealed?”[38]

39 For this cause they couldn’t believe, for Isaiah said again,

40 “He has blinded their eyes and he hardened their heart, lest they should see with their eyes, and perceive with their heart, and would turn, and I would heal them.”[39]

41 Isaiah said these things when he saw his glory, and spoke of him.[40]

42 Nevertheless even of the rulers many believed in him, but because of the Pharisees they didn’t confess it, so that they wouldn’t be put out of the synagogue,

43 for they loved men’s praise more than God’s praise.[41]

44 Jesus cried out and said, “Whoever believes in me, believes not in me, but in him who sent me.

45 He who sees me sees him who sent me.

46 I have come as a light into the world, that whoever believes in me may not remain in the darkness.

47 If anyone listens to my sayings, and doesn’t believe, I don’t judge him. For I came not to judge the world, but to save the world.

48 He who rejects me, and doesn’t receive my sayings, has one who judges him. The word that I spoke, the same will judge him in the last day.

---

[36] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 52:13 • Isaiah 11:10 - *my servant exalted and lifted up and very high, and the nations seeking the root of Jesse, a banner of the peoples*

[37] **Cross-Reference:** Psalm 89:36-37 • Isaiah 9:7 - *his offspring enduring forever and his throne like the sun, and no end to his government on David’s throne*

[38] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 53:1 - *who has believed our message, and to whom has the arm of Yahweh been revealed*

[39] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 6:10 - *make the heart of this people fat and shut their eyes, lest they see and turn again and be healed*

[40] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Isaiah 6:1-3 • Isaiah 52:13 - *the Lord on a throne high and lifted up with the seraphim crying holy, holy, holy, and the servant exalted and lifted up*

[41] **Cross-Reference:** Proverbs 29:25 • 1 Samuel 15:24 - *the fear of man is a snare, and Saul sinning because he feared the people and obeyed their voice*

49 For I spoke not from myself, but the Father who sent me, he gave me a commandment, what I should say, and what I should speak.[42]

50 I know that his commandment is eternal life. The things therefore which I speak, even as the Father has said to me, so I speak."

[42] **Prophecy Fulfilled:** Deuteronomy 18:18-19 - *my words in his mouth, and whoever will not listen to the words he speaks in my name, I will require it of him*

Major Themes Across John 10-12

- False shepherds who threw a healed sheep over the wall
- A shepherd who calls his own by name and goes before them
- The door, lying across the gap so nothing passes but over Him
- Life overflowing, not life barely kept
- Yahweh Himself the shepherd, and David's son set over the flock, both at once
- A hired hand who runs, and an owner who lays down his life
- Other sheep, one flock, one shepherd
- A life no one took, laid down and taken up on His own authority
- One hand holding the sheep, called His and the Father's
- I and the Father are one, the Shema spoken from within
- The one set apart and sent, at the feast of setting apart
- Everything John said about Him proved true
- A message that named the need and trusted the love
- Love and delay joined by the word therefore
- Thomas the doubter as the man who said let us die with Him
- Martha's correct theology meeting the resurrection in person
- Truth for Martha and tears for Mary, after the same sentence
- Anger at death and tears at a tomb He was about to empty
- Faith on the road faltering at the stone
- A dead man called by name, and grave clothes loosed by others
- The miracle that sealed His death
- A prophecy spoken unknowingly by the high priest who wanted Him dead
- Scattered children gathered into one
- A pound of nard and a house filled with its fragrance
- The loudest objection to worship coming from the thief
- Palm branches of the feast and Hosanna on the road
- A King lowly enough to ride a donkey's colt
- Greeks asking to see Him, and the hour arriving
- A grain of wheat buried to become a harvest
- John's Gethsemane: for this hour I came
- One voice from heaven heard as thunder, an angel, or the Father
- Lifted up, meaning the death He would die and the people He would draw

- Isaiah’s throne vision, and John saying the one on it was Yahshua
- High and lifted up: the throne and the cross in the same words
- Belief that stayed hidden for love of the praise of men

Benediction

Let this be the word that goes before us tonight:

May we know the Shepherd’s voice and follow no other.

May we hear Him call us by name.

May we come in by the door and find pasture.

May we have life, and have it overflowing.

May we never be hired hands who run when the wolf comes.

May we rest in the hand no one can snatch us out of.

May we be one flock under one Shepherd.

May what was said about us, like John, prove true.

May we send Him the need and trust His love.

May we read His delays through His love and not the other way around.

May we have Thomas’s courage even on our doubting days.

May we meet the resurrection and the life on the road.

May He weep with us before He raises what we lost.

May we roll away the stone even when we are sure it stinks.

May we hear Him call us out by name.

May we help loose those He has already raised.

May we not count the cost of pouring out everything on Him.

May our worship fill the whole house.

May we never criticize what someone else pours out on Him.

May we cry Hosanna to the King who comes lowly.

May we be willing to fall into the ground and die, and bear much fruit.

May we hate our life in this world and keep it for eternal life.

May we say, for this hour I came.

May we hear the Father’s voice and not call it thunder.

May we be drawn to Him who was lifted up.

May we see His glory as Isaiah saw it.

May we love the praise of God more than the praise of men.

May we confess Him openly and never keep Him hidden.

May every promise He has spoken over us stand up, come forth, and manifest in its appointed time.

Amen.